

the assumption that all property doubles every seven to ten years. The truth is, some real estate doubles and some doesn't. That's because there are property markets within property markets—some are defined by geography, some by price point and some by the type of property—and not all perform at the same level. Some real estate will outperform the market in some years, whereas some will fall in value.

But let's keep extrapolating this Money Story that all real estate will double in value. The average price of a property in Sydney and Melbourne in December 2019, according to Domain.com.au, was \$1,142,212 and \$901,951 respectively. If we use an average of seven per cent growth per year, that would mean the value of these properties in twenty five years would be \$6,199,279 and \$4,895,278. The problem is, the average Wage Price Index (WPI) has grown at an annual average of just 2.2 per cent in the last five years. The average wage for full-time adults, according to the Australian Bureau of Statistics, in November 2019 was \$86,268, and if we calculate this forward using the WPI, in twenty five years the average wage would be \$148,635 which means the average house in Sydney would cost just under 42 times your wage. A strikingly unaffordable gap. Perhaps this is why experts today are calling out the doubling effect of property in our capital cities as a money myth. Yet, it's a money myth I hear too often spoken as unquestionable truth.

Other Money Stories might revolve around who controls the money in a relationship, whether money is good, bad or okay, and perhaps even whether a man should always look after his romantic partner financially. Let's look at this last Money Story.

It seems such a romantic, old-fashioned, harmless sentiment. But what does it mean for a couple when the woman earns more than her male partner? Does it prevent her asking for pay rises because she doesn't want to emasculate him? Or might it cause a single woman to press pause on her financial goals until she meets her prince charming? Does it mean money can't be spoken about in a romantic relationship where a man is earning less? And what does it mean for gay couples?

We might also consider the often-spouted Money Story that women are spenders and men are savers. Or that men are better at finances than women. To find out whether this Money Story has truth, and where its origins lie, we could start by looking at general stories women believe that